ENGLISH B2 · ADVANCED GRAMMAR

Reason, result and purpose clauses

Distinguish because and because of, so and so that, therefore and in order to when connecting causes, outcomes and intentions. The lesson connects form, meaning, register and real editorial decisions rather than treating the pattern as an isolated rule.

THE CENTRAL IDEA

Use reason, result and purpose clauses to make the logical relation between two ideas explicit without confusing cause, consequence and intended goal while preserving the intended meaning and register.

Distinguish because and because of, so and so that, therefore and in order to when connecting causes, outcomes and intentions.

MODEL

We duplicated the records so that no data would be lost.

because + clause | because of + noun | so that + clause | therefore + result

6 GUIDED STAGES · 30 LEARNING DECISIONS

This complete guide combines explanation, visual reasoning, practice and feedback. Separate exercise and answer-key editions are also available from the lesson page.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

OUTCOME 1

01

Recognise the main reason, result and purpose clauses patterns in authentic contexts.

OUTCOME 2

02

Choose a form that accurately expresses make the logical relation between two ideas explicit without confusing cause, consequence and intended goal.

OUTCOME 3

03

Avoid errors that change time, agency, emphasis or speaker commitment.

OUTCOME 4

04

Use the structure appropriately in explanation, procedure, argument and project communication.

Build meaning before form

Distinguish because and because of, so and so that, therefore and in order to when connecting causes, outcomes and intentions.

What reason, result and purpose clauses communicates

Distinguish because and because of, so and so that, therefore and in order to when connecting causes, outcomes and intentions.

The central purpose is to make the logical relation between two ideas explicit without confusing cause, consequence and intended goal. A successful choice therefore preserves the proposition while making the intended relationship, viewpoint or degree of commitment visible to the reader.

The launch was delayed because the final test failed.	the cause that explains an event
We duplicated the records so that no data would be lost.	the goal that motivated an action
The evidence was incomplete; therefore, the review remained open.	a consequence drawn from the previous proposition

How the pattern is built

Use this working formula: because + clause | because of + noun | so that + clause | therefore + result. The formula is a decision path: it identifies the trigger, the clause architecture and the element that carries tense or modality.

The model “We duplicated the records so that no data would be lost.” shows the complete pattern in context. Rebuild the sentence from meaning to form instead of translating each word independently.

Choice	Structure	Example
Reason	because + clause / because of + noun	The launch was delayed because the final test failed.
Intended purpose	so that + subject + modal	We duplicated the records so that no data would be lost.
Logical result	therefore/consequently + clause	The evidence was incomplete; therefore, the review remained open.

Choose by meaning, not by surface similarity

Neighbouring structures may contain similar words but perform different jobs. Compare the three reference patterns and name the intended effect before completing the sentence.

A reliable answer explains both why the chosen form works and why a plausible alternative would change the meaning, time relation, information focus or level of certainty.

Meaning	Best route
the cause that explains an event	Reason
the goal that motivated an action	Intended purpose
a consequence drawn from the previous proposition	Logical result

Register, discourse and editorial control

This grammar is especially useful in explanation, procedure, argument and project communication. Its value comes from helping the reader process a relationship efficiently, not from making the sentence sound artificially complex.

After editing, check recoverability, natural word order and consistency with the surrounding paragraph. If the marked structure creates ambiguity, return to a fuller or more neutral clause.

Reason through the pattern

The visual map moves from communicative purpose to structural trigger, then to the final clause. It keeps meaning and form visible at the same time so the learner can justify every choice.

01	02	03	04	05	06	07	08
because	clause	because of	noun	so that	clause	therefore	result

DECIDE IN THIS ORDER

STEP 1

Decision 1

Identify the communicative purpose before selecting a form: make the logical relation between two ideas explicit without confusing cause, consequence and intended goal.

STEP 2

Decision 2

Locate the structural trigger and match it to one of the reference patterns.

STEP 3

Decision 3

Check time reference, clause relationships, agency and speaker commitment.

STEP 4

Decision 4

Read the complete sentence in context and confirm that its register suits explanation, procedure, argument and project communication.

STEP 5

Decision 5

Compare the result with a neutral alternative and keep the marked form only when it adds useful meaning.

Compare forms and meanings

Use the table to justify each structural choice.

Pattern	Form	Model
Reason	because + clause / because of + noun	The launch was delayed because the final test failed.
Intended purpose	so that + subject + modal	We duplicated the records so that no data would be lost.
Logical result	therefore/consequently + clause	The evidence was incomplete; therefore, the review remained open.

EXAMPLES AT A GLANCE

The launch was delayed because the final test failed.	the cause that explains an event
We duplicated the records so that no data would be lost.	the goal that motivated an action
The evidence was incomplete; therefore, the review remained open.	a consequence drawn from the previous proposition

COMMON ERRORS

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not follow because of with a finite clause.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not treat so that as a simple result marker when intention is central.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not join independent clauses with therefore without appropriate punctuation.

Recognition in context

Choose the sentence whose grammar matches the stated communicative purpose.

A1 · MEANING DECISION 1

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: the cause that explains an event?

OPTIONS The launch was delayed because the final test failed. · We duplicated the records so that no data would be lost. · The evidence was incomplete; therefore, the review remained open.

A2 · MEANING DECISION 2

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: the goal that motivated an action?

OPTIONS We duplicated the records so that no data would be lost. · The evidence was incomplete; therefore, the review remained open. · The launch was delayed because the final test failed.

A3 · MEANING DECISION 3

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a consequence drawn from the previous proposition?

OPTIONS The evidence was incomplete; therefore, the review remained open. · The launch was delayed because the final test failed. · We duplicated the records so that no data would be lost.

A4 · INTERPRETATION 4

What does “The launch was delayed because the final test failed.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS the cause that explains an event · the goal that motivated an action · a consequence drawn from the previous proposition

A5 · INTERPRETATION 5

What does “We duplicated the records so that no data would be lost.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS the goal that motivated an action · a consequence drawn from the previous proposition · the cause that explains an event

A6 · INTERPRETATION 6

What does “The evidence was incomplete; therefore, the review remained open.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a consequence drawn from the previous proposition · the cause that explains an event · the goal that motivated an action

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Form and function

Identify both the structural family and the meaning carried by each model.

B1 · FORM AND FUNCTION 1

“The launch was delayed because the final test failed.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Reason / Intended purpose / Logical result · Gap 2: the cause that explains an event / the goal that motivated an action / a consequence drawn from the previous proposition

B2 · FORM AND FUNCTION 2

“We duplicated the records so that no data would be lost.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Intended purpose / Logical result / Reason · Gap 2: the goal that motivated an action / a consequence drawn from the previous proposition / the cause that explains an event

B3 · FORM AND FUNCTION 3

“The evidence was incomplete; therefore, the review remained open.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Logical result / Reason / Intended purpose · Gap 2: a consequence drawn from the previous proposition / the cause that explains an event / the goal that motivated an action

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Guided discourse choices

Maintain accurate form and meaning across a connected sequence of decisions.

C1 · EDITORIAL PLANNING

Choose the model that expresses the cause that explains an event: _____. Choose the model that expresses the goal that motivated an action: _____. Choose the model that expresses a consequence drawn from the previous proposition: _____. Choose the model built with because + clause / because of + noun: _____. Choose the model built with so that + subject + modal: _____. Choose the model built with therefore/consequently + clause: _____.

_____
_____

WORD BANK

Available forms

The evidence was incomplete; therefore, the review remained open. · The launch was delayed because the final test failed. · We duplicated the records so that no data would be lost.

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Open reconstruction

Recover the missing structural trigger without a word bank.

D1 · INDEPENDENT RECONSTRUCTION

The launch was delayed _____. We duplicated the records _____. The evidence was incomplete; _____, the review remained open. State the full structural pattern for Reason: _____. State the full structural pattern for Intended purpose: _____.

_____
_____
_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Controlled transformation

Rewrite the neutral source so that it performs the requested advanced function.

E1 · TRANSFORMATION 1

Rewrite “The failed test caused the delay.” using the Reason pattern to express the cause that explains an event.

_____
_____

E2 · TRANSFORMATION 2

Rewrite “Preventing data loss was the reason for making copies.” using the Intended purpose pattern to express the goal that motivated an action.

_____
_____

E3 · TRANSFORMATION 3

Rewrite “Incomplete evidence caused the review to remain open.” using the Logical result pattern to express a consequence drawn from the previous proposition.

_____
_____

E4 · TRANSFORMATION 4

Rewrite “The failed test caused the delay.” using the Reason pattern to express the cause that explains an event.

_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Communicative production

Use the grammar independently in realistic academic, professional and conversational contexts.

F1 · PRODUCTION TASK 1

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Reason to express the cause that explains an event, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F2 · PRODUCTION TASK 2

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Intended purpose to express the goal that motivated an action, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F3 · PRODUCTION TASK 3

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Logical result to express a consequence drawn from the previous proposition, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

07 · RETRIEVAL

Final self-check

Complete these prompts without reopening the guide.

R1 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: communicative purpose.

_____
_____
_____

R2 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: structural trigger.

_____
_____
_____

R3 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: meaning contrast.

_____
_____
_____

R4 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: register choice.

_____
_____
_____

Recognition in context

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

A1

The launch was delayed because the final test failed.

Reason is the best match because the cause that explains an event.

A2

We duplicated the records so that no data would be lost.

Intended purpose is the best match because the goal that motivated an action.

A3

The evidence was incomplete; therefore, the review remained open.

Logical result is the best match because a consequence drawn from the previous proposition.

A4

the cause that explains an event

The Reason pattern communicates the cause that explains an event.

A5

the goal that motivated an action

The Intended purpose pattern communicates the goal that motivated an action.

A6

a consequence drawn from the previous proposition

The Logical result pattern communicates a consequence drawn from the previous proposition.

Form and function

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

B1

Reason / the cause that explains an event

The structure belongs to the Reason pattern. Its communicative purpose is the cause that explains an event.

B2

Intended purpose / the goal that motivated an action

The structure belongs to the Intended purpose pattern. Its communicative purpose is the goal that motivated an action.

B3

Logical result / a consequence drawn from the previous proposition

The structure belongs to the Logical result pattern. Its communicative purpose is a consequence drawn from the previous proposition.

Guided discourse choices

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

C1

The launch was delayed because the final test failed.

Reason: because + clause / because of + noun.

C2

We duplicated the records so that no data would be lost.

Intended purpose: so that + subject + modal.

C3

The evidence was incomplete; therefore, the review remained open.

Logical result: therefore/consequently + clause.

C4

The launch was delayed because the final test failed.

Reason: because + clause / because of + noun.

C5

We duplicated the records so that no data would be lost.

Intended purpose: so that + subject + modal.

C6

The evidence was incomplete; therefore, the review remained open.

Logical result: therefore/consequently + clause.

Open reconstruction

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

D1

because the final test failed

Reason requires “because the final test failed” in this model. because + clause / because of + noun.

D2

so that no data would be lost

Intended purpose requires “so that no data would be lost” in this model. so that + subject + modal.

D3

therefore

Logical result requires “therefore” in this model. therefore/consequently + clause.

D4

because + clause / because of + noun

Reason is built as because + clause / because of + noun.

D5

so that + subject + modal

Intended purpose is built as so that + subject + modal.

Controlled transformation

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

E1

The launch was delayed because the final test failed.

because + clause / because of + noun. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended reason effect.

E2

We duplicated the records so that no data would be lost.

so that + subject + modal. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended intended purpose effect.

E3

The evidence was incomplete; therefore, the review remained open.

therefore/consequently + clause. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended logical result effect.

E4

The launch was delayed because the final test failed.

because + clause / because of + noun. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended reason effect.

Communicative production

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

F1

The launch was delayed because the final test failed. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses because + clause / because of + noun accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F2

We duplicated the records so that no data would be lost. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses so that + subject + modal accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F3

The evidence was incomplete; therefore, the review remained open. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses therefore/consequently + clause accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

Diagnose the pattern, not only the score

Use this page to decide what to revisit in the complete guide.

CHECK · TRIGGER OR CONTEXT

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · AUXILIARY OR STRUCTURAL CHOICE

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MAIN VERB OR CLAUSE FORM

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MEANING AND REGISTER

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____